



RIP Xbox One

Microsoft has discontinued production of all variants of the Xbox One Consoles.
<https://digit.in/feb22-66>



Nigeria lifts ban on Twitter

After 7 months, Nigerians can finally access Twitter without using a VPN.
<https://digit.in/feb22-67>

keys. As long as it's within range of someone's iPhone, iPad, Apple Watch or any other Apple Product that connects to the internet, that AirTag can be tracked by the owner.

And that, is the biggest problem of all with AirTag. It's brightest and boldest feature is also what makes AirTag such potent weapons to be used against others.

THE BAD

While it's great to be able to track your own AirTag, to find your own things, what if someone uses it to track possessions that are not their own? Apple was quick to look at this problem and allow you to use your iPhone to let you know when a rogue or unknown AirTag was nearby for long enough. For example, someone attaching their AirTag to your bag would cause your own iPhone to warn you that an AirTag was following you where you went. Now, your friends who are travelling with you or the one's your spending time with might have AirTags of their own, which you would get warned about – false positives. And you were out of luck if you had an Android phone, which most people on the planet have!

Android woes

In 2021, Apple released an app called Tracker Detect to help users of Android 9 (or later) detect strange AirTags that are following them. This needs us Android users to use an Apple app to protect ourselves from rogue Apple users trying to track us or our possessions! There's got to be a lawsuit in there somewhere. Right? The app doesn't run in the background wither, it only detects AirTags when you keep it open,

and then it allows you to command the AirTag to play a sound so you can find it. That in itself is open to mischief.

Car theft

Thieves in New York and in Canada have already used Apple AirTags to tag a car in a public parking lot and track it back to its owner's home. This is used in multiple ways. A thief spots a luxury car, then uses the AirTag to track the car to a more secluded location where they can steal the car without being seen. Secondly, a luxury car owner usually has expensive items in their home, and tracking the car home lets thugs know which house to target. The same AirTag on the car will let them know when the house is empty as the owner is out with his or her car.

Since September 2021, there have been quite a few instances where criminals stole premium autos using AirTags. They usually hide the AirTag on the target vehicle in an inconspicuous spot, such as the tow hitch or the fuel cap.

THE UGLY



Image Source: Forbes

While Apple claims to use methods to prevent unwanted tracking or stalking, a Washington Post article (amongst others) found that it was discovered that it was "frighteningly easy" to circumvent the safeguards set in place. For one, the inbuilt audio alarm only rings after three days, which might be three days too late. For example if a stalker or predator wanted to follow a woman or child home, and placed an AirTag in their belongings, you want to know immediately not three days later! It is also not hard to disable the audio capa-

bility of an AirTag by forcing it open and removing the speaker magnet. Such an alteration of the AirTag does not disable it. It should! Several women were stalked using AirTags in 2022.

Though to be fair, Apple isn't the only company making such technology, and they're certainly the company who is doing the most to protect innocent users from becoming victims of this technology.

Sometimes having very old technology helps! The Ultra Wideband that AirTags use isn't supported everywhere, and Precision Finding won't work in the following countries:

- | | |
|--------------|-------------------|
| • Argentina | • Pakistan |
| • Armenia | • Paraguay |
| • Azerbaijan | • Russia |
| • Belarus | • Solomon Islands |
| • Indonesia | • Tajikistan |
| • Kazakhstan | • Turkmenistan |
| • Kyrgyzstan | • Ukraine |
| • Nepal | • Uzbekistan |

Notice that India is not part of that list, because we have modern generation technology and networks – a bad thing in this case, so you're prone to someone using AirTags or other similar devices against you!

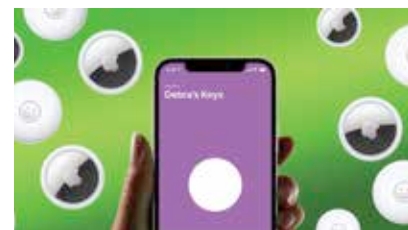


Image Source: Screen Rant

THE VERDICT

Technology is usually never good or bad, it's humans that use them to do good or bad. We cannot blame Apple and their AirTag for an increased risk to the safety of primarily women and children (though men too are at risk). However we can blame ourselves if we don't inform everyone vulnerable we know about the risks and learn how to minimise them. For starters, if you're an Android user (and most of you are), get the Android App from <https://digit.in/noairtag> and keep yourself safe. 



Image Source: Newsy Today